

DECLARED CONTRACTS · WHAT THEY PAINT

# The muted tier, split

Four color tokens whose declared contract did not match what they painted.

**One token was doing two jobs with two different floors.**

#### MUTED TEXT

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- Captions, table headers, slide chrome. Was sub-AA on 44 of 72 pairs, worst 2.11:1. Now clears 4.5:1 on both surfaces, everywhere.

#### MUTED DECORATION

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- Rules, hairlines, skipped marks, low-alpha washes. Moved to a mark token at the 3:1 graphical floor; 32 of 36 values unchanged.

# Muted text still reads as muted — and now it reads.

| PALETTE          | MUTED TEXT WAS | NOW    | SEPARATION FROM BODY |
|------------------|----------------|--------|----------------------|
| magnolia / light | 2.11:1         | 4.67:1 | 0.240                |
| cuoio / light    | 2.43:1         | 4.65:1 | 0.038                |
| concrete / dark  | 2.95:1         | 4.67:1 | 0.065                |
| indaco / dark    | 3.68:1         | 4.66:1 | 0.230                |

# The decoration tier keeps its quiet.

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Empty and skipped state marks

Card rules and table hairlines

Low-alpha cell washes

Radar bands and grid lines

# Syntax colors are grouped by what survives the condition.

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```
// Six groups, not twelve: a twelve-way color distinction does not  
// survive a dichromacy, and none of it survives achromatopsia.  
function separationUnder(condition, roles) {  
  const seen = simulate(roles, condition);  // the reader's actual colors  
  const worst = minPairwiseDistance(seen);  // not the authored ones  
  return worst >= (condition === 'achromatopsia' ? 0.048 : 0.11);  
}
```

# The rim is ink again, not the brand hue.

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A token declared nowhere means the fallback wins on every theme, forever — and this rim was landing in the same hue family as the wash it exists to seat against.

# Same phantom, same repair.

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Both rims now read a contract token directly, so they need no fallback at all — which also removes the chain the contract ledger was tracking.

# Three gates, each one bitten before its green was trusted.

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## PHANTOM READS

A token nothing declares and nothing writes. Runtime-set is proven by a write.

## MUTED TIER FLOORS

4.5 for the text half, 3.0 for the mark half. Fails closed on an unreadable value.

## SYNTAX SEPARATION

The ally families under simulation — contrast alone passed the whole time.